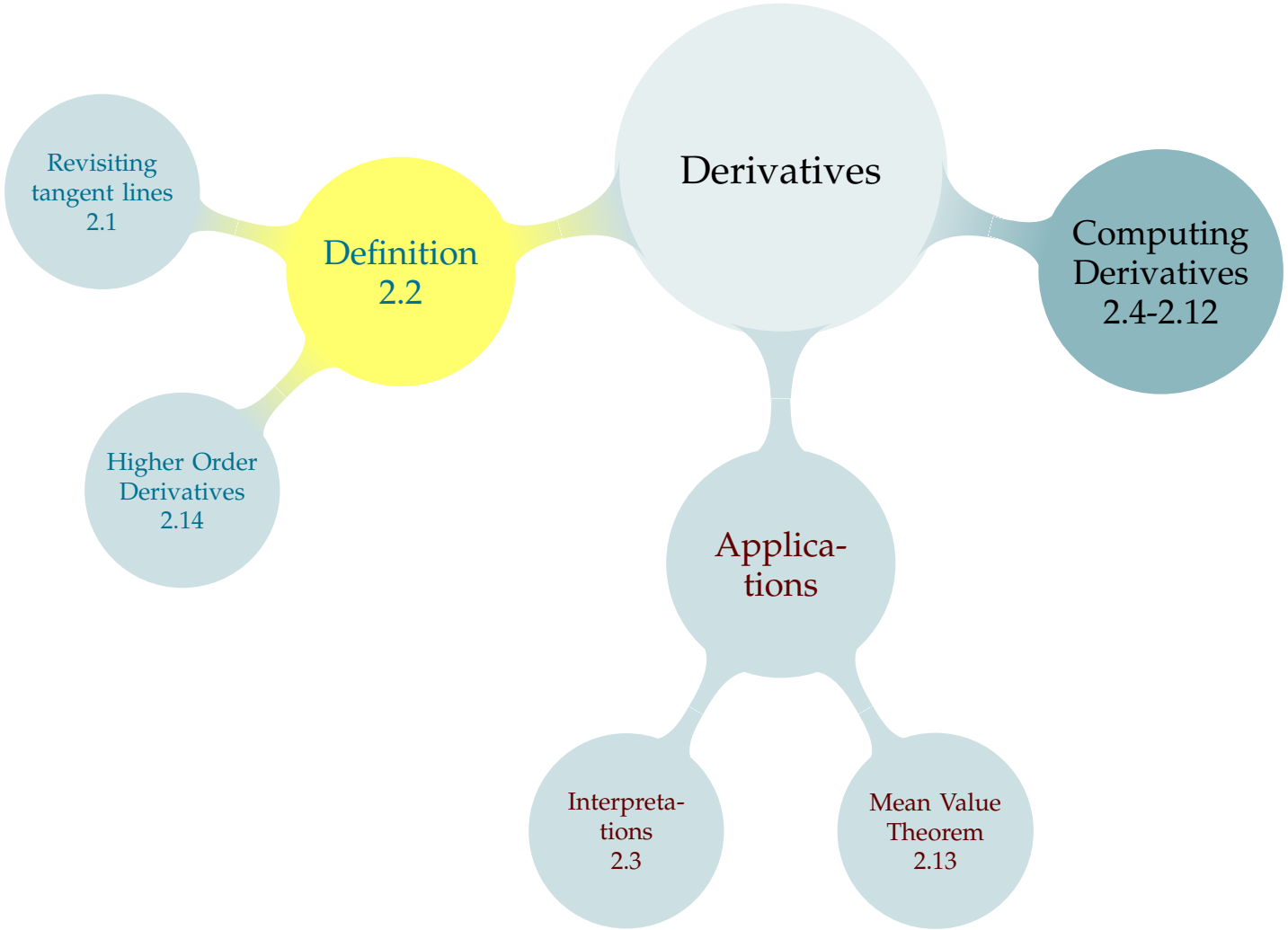
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Derivative at a Point

Definition 2.2.1

Given a function $f(x)$ and a point a, the slope of the tangent line to $f(x)$ at a is the derivative of f at a, written $f'(a)$.

So, $f'(a) = \lim_{h \to 0} \dfrac{f(a+h) - f(a)}{h}$.

$f'(a)$ is also the instantaneous rate of change of f at a.

Derivative

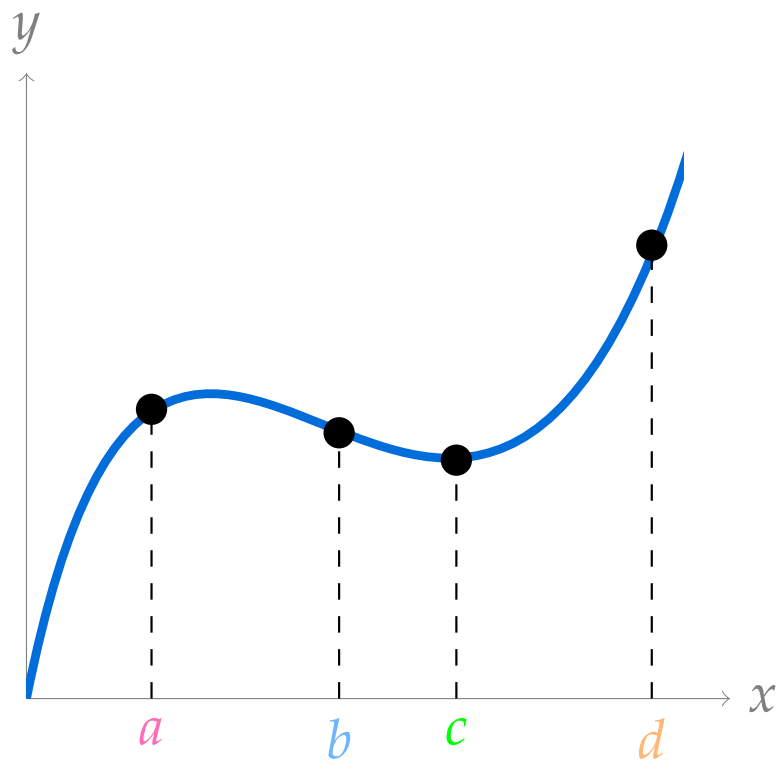
$$f'(a) = \lim_{h \to 0} \frac{f(a+h) - f(a)}{h}$$

If $f'(a) > 0$, then f is increasing at a. Its graph "points up."

If $f'(a) < 0$, then f is decreasing at a. Its graph "points down."

If $f'(a) = 0$, then f looks constant or flat at a.

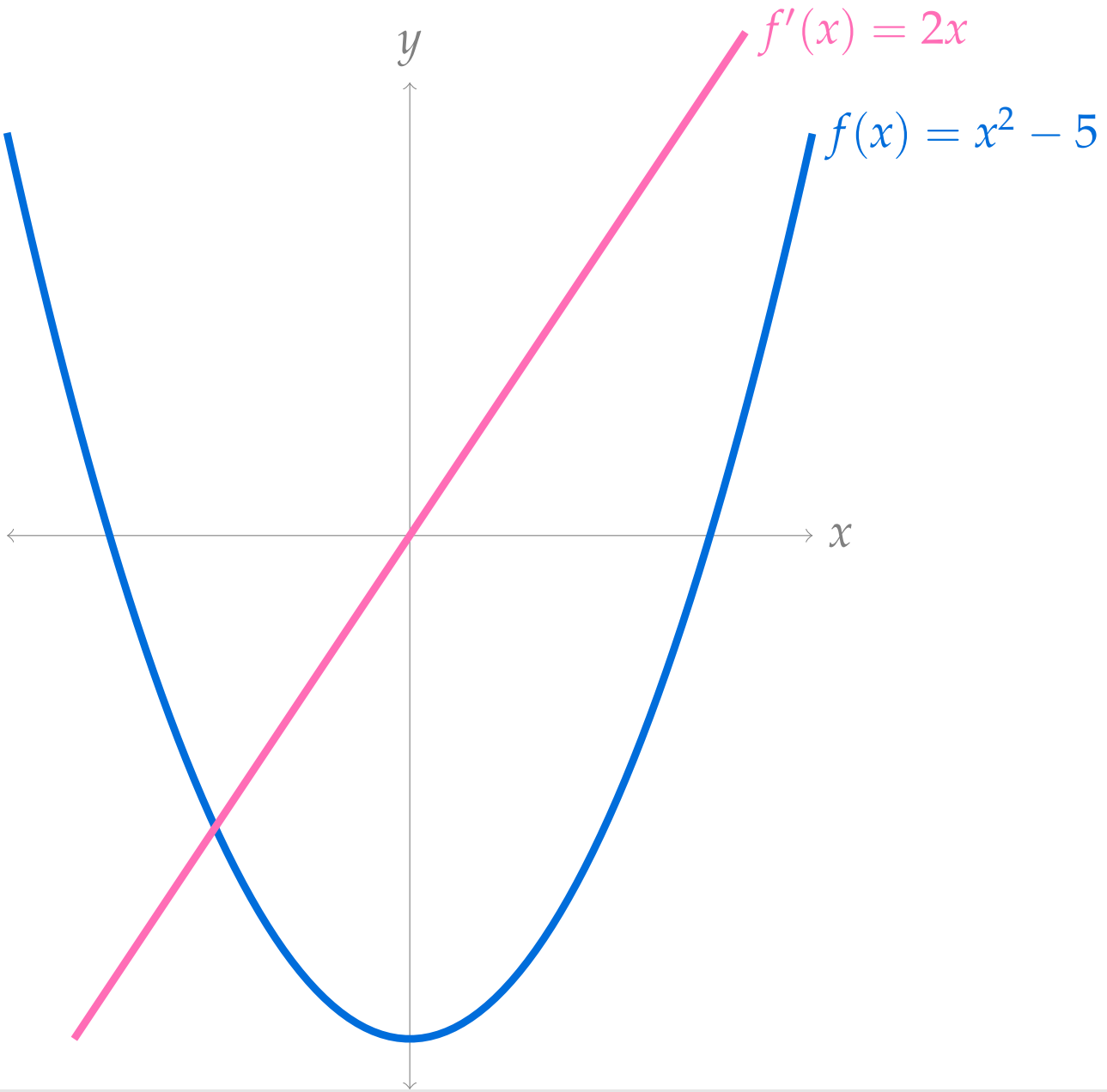
Practice: Increasing and Decreasing



Where is $f'(x) < 0$? Where is $f'(x) > 0$? Where is $f'(x) \approx 0$?

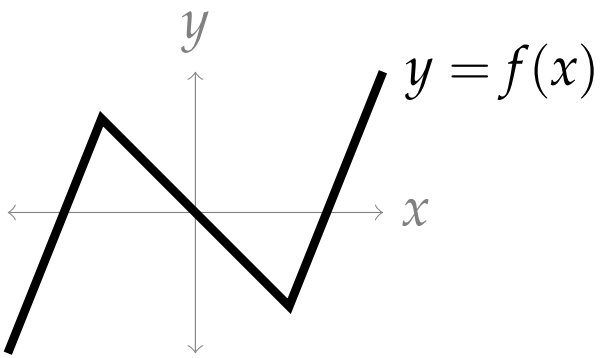
Use the definition of the derivative to find the slope of the tangent line to $f(x) = x^2 - 5$ at the point $x = 3$.

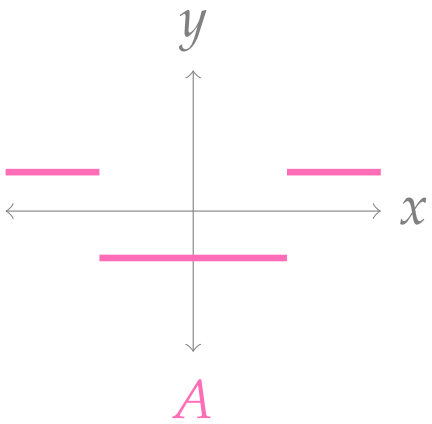
Let's keep the function $f(x) = x^2 - 5$. We just showed $f'(3) = 6$. We can also find its derivative at an arbitrary point x:


$f'(x) = 2x$
$f(x) = x^2 - 5$
y
x

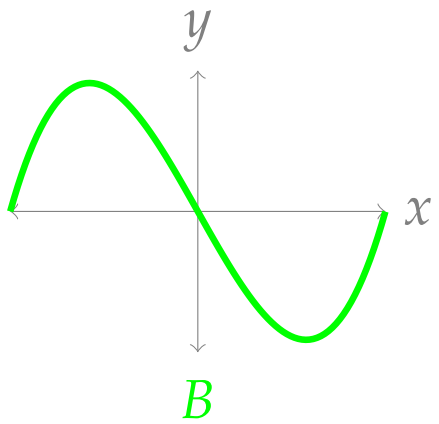
Increasing and Decreasing

In black is the curve $y = f(x)$. Which of the coloured curves corresponds to $y = f'(x)$?

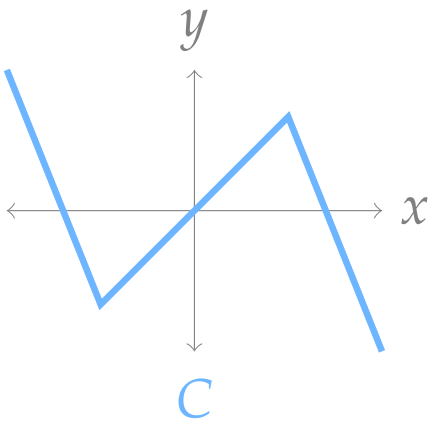




A



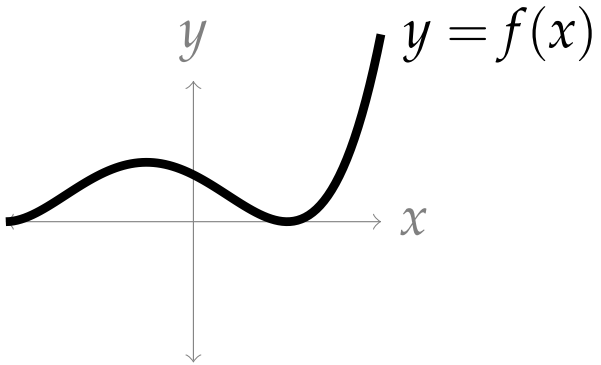
B

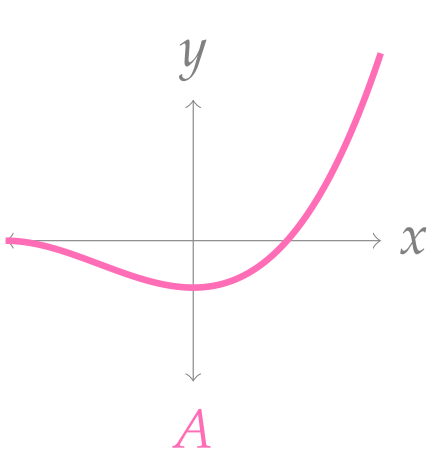


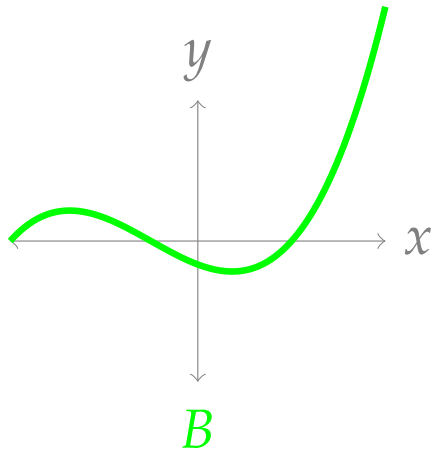
C

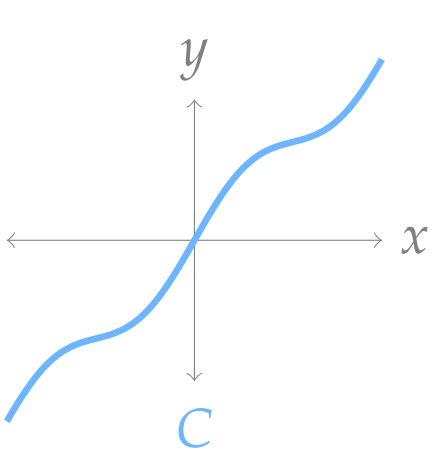
Increasing and Decreasing

In black is the curve $y = f(x)$. Which of the coloured curves corresponds to $y = f'(x)$?









Derivative as a Function – Definition 2.2.6

Let $f(x)$ be a function.
The derivative of $f(x)$ with respect to x is given by

$$f'(x) = \lim_{h \to 0} \frac{f(x+h) - f(x)}{h},$$

provided the limit exists. Notice that x will be a part of your final expression: this is a function.

If $f'(x)$ exists for all x in an interval (a, b), we say that f is differentiable on (a, b).

Notation 2.2.8

The "prime" notation $f'(x)$ and $f'(a)$ is sometimes called Newtonian notation. We will also use Leibnitz notation:

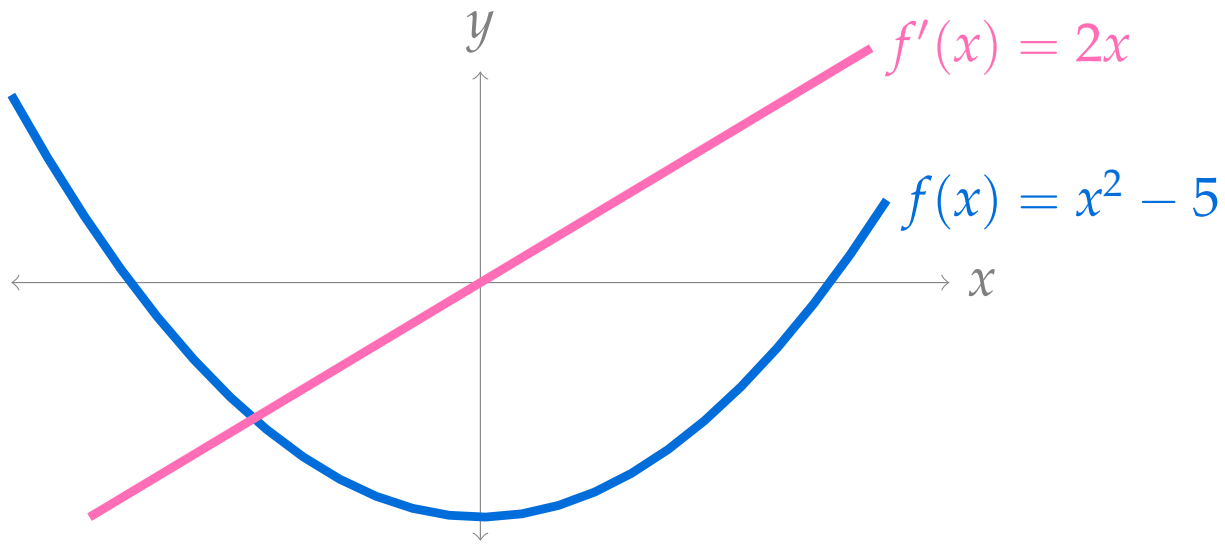
$\frac{df}{dx}$	$\frac{df}{dx}(a)$	$\frac{d}{dx}f(x)$	$\left.\frac{d}{dx}f(x)\right\|_{x=a}$
function	number	function	number

Newtonian Notation:

$$f(x) = x^2 + 5 \qquad f'(x) = 2x \qquad f'(3) = 6$$

Leibnitz Notation:

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}f}{\mathrm{d}x} = \qquad \frac{\mathrm{d}f}{\mathrm{d}x}(3) = \qquad \frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}x}f(x) = \qquad \left.\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}x}f(x)\right|_{x=3} =$$



Alternate Definition – Definition 2.2.1

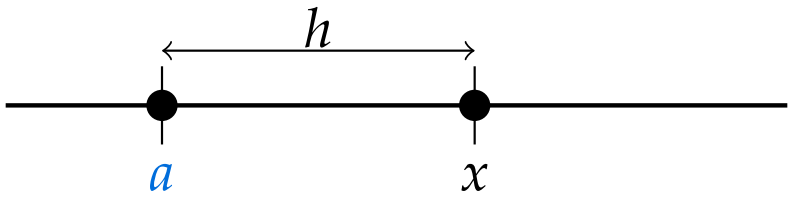
Calculating

$$f'(a) = \lim_{h \to 0} \frac{f(a+h) - f(a)}{h}$$

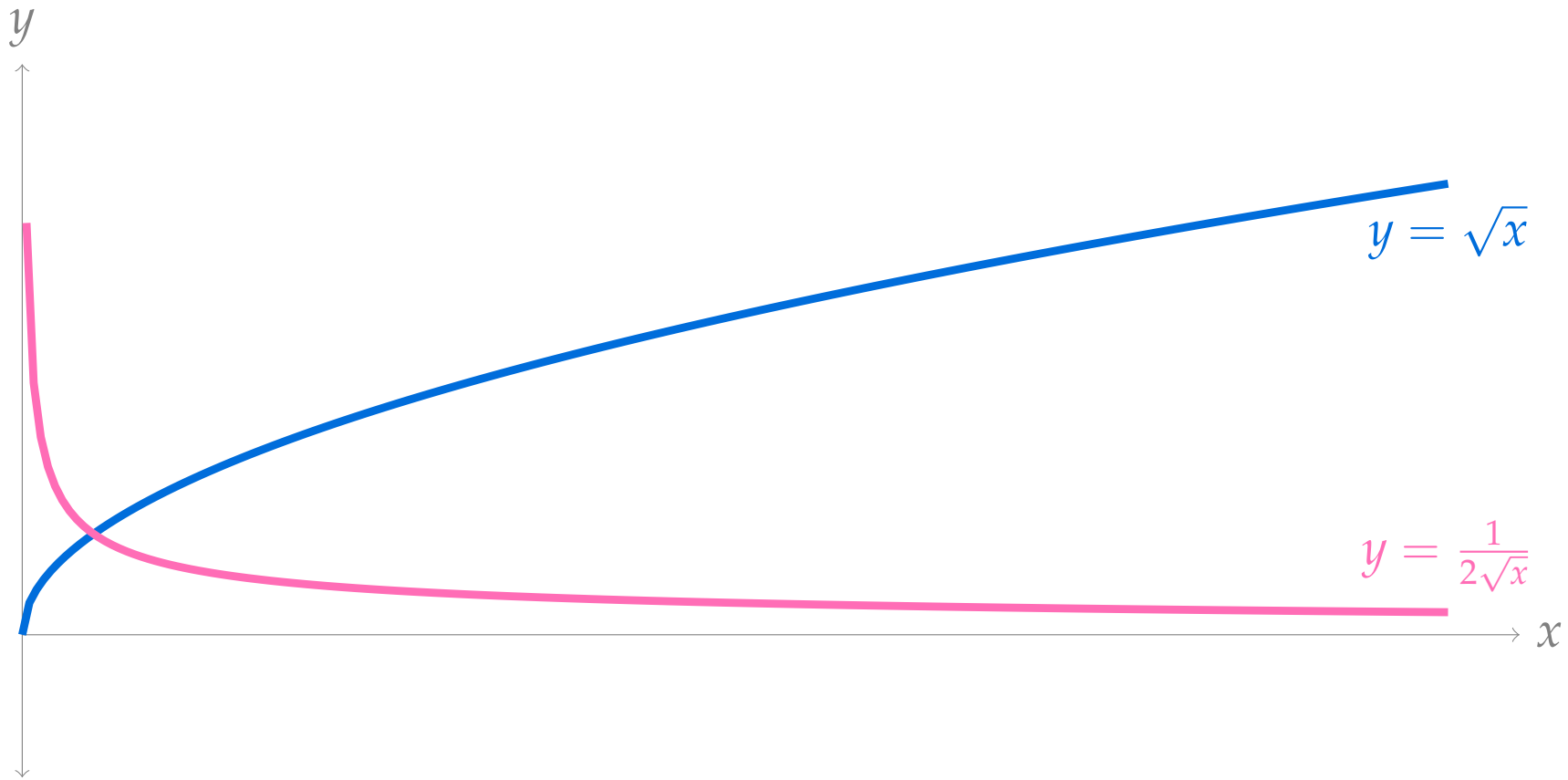
is the same as calculating

$$f'(x) = \lim_{x \to a} \frac{f(x) - f(a)}{x - a}.$$

Notice in these scenarios, $h = x - a$.



Let $f(x) = \sqrt{x}$. Using the definition of a derivative, calculate $f'(x)$.



Review:

$$\lim_{x\to\infty} \sqrt{x} = \qquad \lim_{x\to\infty} \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} =$$

$$\lim_{x\to 0^+} \sqrt{x} = \qquad \lim_{x\to 0^+} \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} =$$

NOW YOU



Using the definition of the derivative, calculate

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}x}\left\{\frac{1}{x}\right\}.$$

Using the definition of the derivative, calculate $\dfrac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}x}\left\{\dfrac{2x}{x+1}\right\}$.

Using the definition of the derivative, calculate $\dfrac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}x}\left\{\dfrac{1}{\sqrt{x^2+x}}\right\}$.

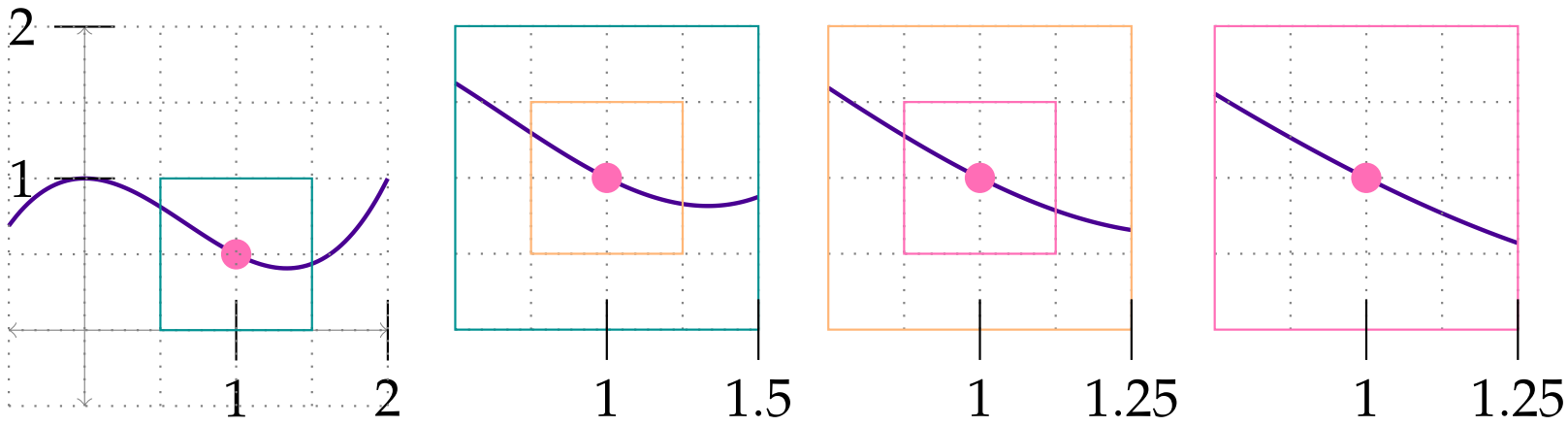
Memorize

The derivative of a function f at a point a is given by the following limit, if it exists:

$$f'(a) = \lim_{h \to 0} \frac{f(a+h) - f(a)}{h}$$

Zooming In

For a smooth function, if we zoom in at a point, we see a line:



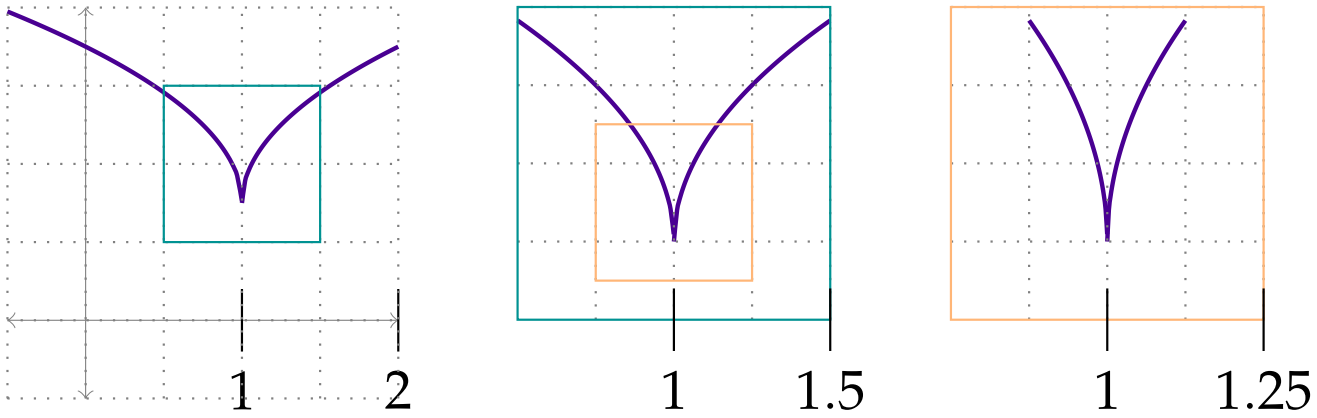
In this example, the slope of our zoomed-in line looks to be about:

$$\frac{\Delta y}{\Delta x} \approx -\frac{1}{2}$$

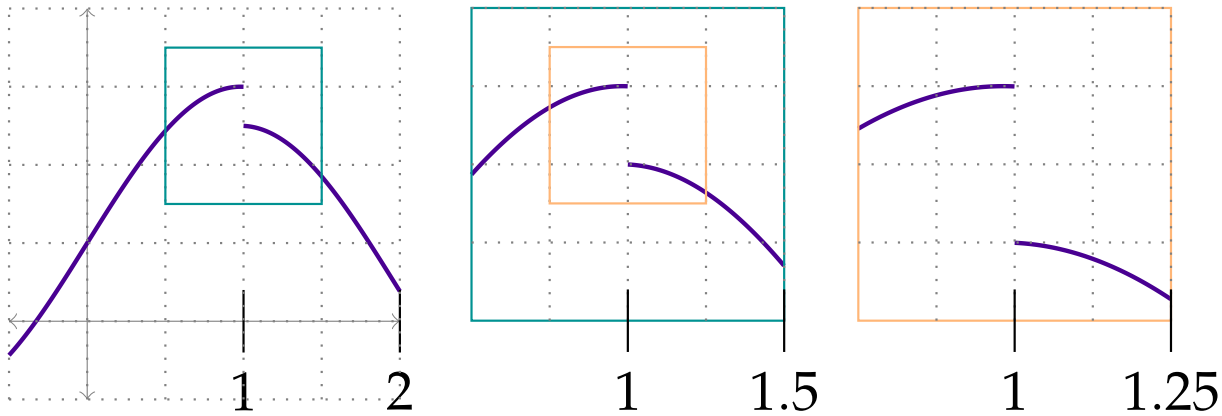
Zooming in on functions that aren't smooth

For a function with a cusp or a discontinuity, even though we zoom in very closely, we don't see simply a single straight line.

Cusp:



Discontinuity:



Alternate Definition – Definition 2.2.1

Calculating

$$f'(a) = \lim_{h \to 0} \frac{f(a+h) - f(a)}{h}$$

is the same as calculating

$$f'(x) = \lim_{x \to a} \frac{f(x) - f(a)}{x - a}.$$

Notice in these scenarios, $h = x - a$.

The derivative of $f(x)$ does not exist at $x = a$ if

$$\lim_{x \to a} \frac{f(x) - f(a)}{x - a}$$

does not exist.
Note this is the slope of the tangent line to $y = f(x)$ at $x = a$, $\frac{\Delta y}{\Delta x}$.

When Derivatives Don't Exist

What happens if we try to calculate a derivative where none exists?

Find the derivative of $f(x) = x^{1/3}$ at $x = 0$.

What happens if we try to calculate a derivative where none exists?

Find the derivative of $f(x) = x^{1/3}$ at $x = 0$.

As usual, it's nice to reassure students that we did not need to know the graph of this function to answer the question. Otherwise, they might unduly worry.

Theorem 2.2.14

If the function $f(x)$ is differentiable at $x = a$, then $f(x)$ is also continuous at $x = a$.

Proof:

Let $f(x)$ be a function and let a be a constant in its domain. Draw a picture of each scenario, or say that it is impossible.

$f(x)$ continuous at $x = a$ $f(x)$ differentiable at $x = a$	$f(x)$ continuous at $x = a$ $f(x)$ not differentiable at $x = a$
$f(x)$ not continuous at $x = a$ $f(x)$ differentiable at $x = a$ impossible	$f(x)$ not continuous at $x = a$ $f(x)$ not differentiable at $x = a$

Included Work

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